Draft: Registration / Interest E-mail to the ABCC Organizers

Send to **aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca** (Judith Jayasuriya, Steven Harrison). Adjust freely — this is a draft, written to get every open question from `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md` answered in one exchange.

Subject: International team interest — ABCC 2027 (HSBI, Germany)

Dear Ms. Jayasuriya, dear Mr. Harrison,

I am a professor at Hochschule Bielefeld (HSBI) — University of Applied Sciences and Arts in Bielefeld, Germany, and I would like to enter a team in the **Asper Business Case Competition 2027** (February 18–22). We have followed the competition's development with great interest — not least Babeș-Bolyai's participation and win in 2026 — and would be delighted to bring a second international team to Winnipeg.

Our team would consist of **four Masters-level students** with backgrounds in finance, innovation management, computer science, and general business administration, accompanied by myself as faculty advisor. Before we finalize planning, could you help us with the following:

1. **Eligibility and entry:** Is a team of Masters-level students from a German business school eligible for the 2027 edition, and what does the registration process for an international school look like? Is there a participation fee, and what does it cover?
2. **Key dates and the competition week:** When will the 2027 Competition Guide be published, and when do you expect the prepared case to be released and due? We also want to be sure we read the dates correctly before booking flights: the website gives **February 18–22, 2027**, which falls Thursday to Monday, whereas the 2024, 2025, and 2026 editions all began on a Wednesday. Should we plan on **registration and the division draw on Thursday, February 18**, with the competition days running Friday to Sunday and departures on Monday, February 22?
3. **Logistics:** Should we book rooms through a competition block at the Delta Hotels Winnipeg, and from which date? Are airport transfers or shuttles provided for arriving teams?
4. **Team formalities:** What information do you need from us and by when (team roster, bios, photos, fictional team name, waivers)? Is there a separate registration step for me as faculty advisor?
5. **Letter of invitation:** Could you issue a formal letter of invitation naming the five travellers and the competition dates? German citizens travel on an eTA rather than a visa, but Canadian border officers routinely ask arriving delegations for one, and our university requires it for travel funding.
6. **2027 rules package:** Do you expect any changes against the 2025 Event Guide baseline we are training on — in particular around the use of generative AI during timed prep (permitted in 2025), any disclosure duties, or case-confidentiality terms that would affect which tools we may use?

We would plan to arrive on February 16 or 17 to allow for the seven-hour time difference, and to depart on February 22 or 23 depending on your answer to question 2. Please let me know if a short call would be easier — I am generally available afternoons CET.

Thank you very much, and congratulations on building such a distinctive competition — the three-round format is precisely why we want to take part.

Kind regards,

Prof. Dr. Christoph Weisser Hochschule Bielefeld (HSBI), Germany [phone] · [institutional e-mail @hsbi.de]

Send it from the HSBI address, not a private one. This is a school-to-school approach — entry is by school, not open sign-up (`01-competition/handbook.md` §3) — so the sender domain is part of the credential. Put a private address in the signature only as a fallback if you want one.

After the reply: transfer every answered deadline into `02-plan/week_by_week_plan.md` and `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md` (open-questions section), tick off the matching lines in the open-questions

list there, and start the eTA/flight track per `07-logistics/travel_logistics.md`. If the answer settles the weekday question, that is the trigger to (a) rewrite the day-sheets in `07-logistics/competition_day_runbook.md` with real dates, (b) delete the "2027 weekday question" section from `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md`, and (c) book flights — the propagation order is in `DOCUMENTATION.md` §5.